



IBM Developer
SKILLS NETWORK

Winning Space Race with Data Science

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IBM Data Science Professional Certificate



Outline

- Executive Summary
- Introduction
- Methodology
- Results
- Conclusion
- Appendix

Executive Summary

- Worked with SpaceX launch data to better understand how launch success might be determined
- Launch success was found to be related to a variety of factors
 - Orbit type
 - Payload mass
 - Date (improvement over time)
- Launch site locations appear to be dependent on a variety of factors
 - Proximity to landmarks such as coastline, railways, cities

Introduction

- The goal of the project is to determine when the first stage of Falcon 9 will land successfully
 - Reusing a launch's first stage reduces the cost of the launch significantly
 - If we can determine when the first stage gets reused, we can more easily predict launch pricing

Section 1

Methodology

Methodology

Executive Summary

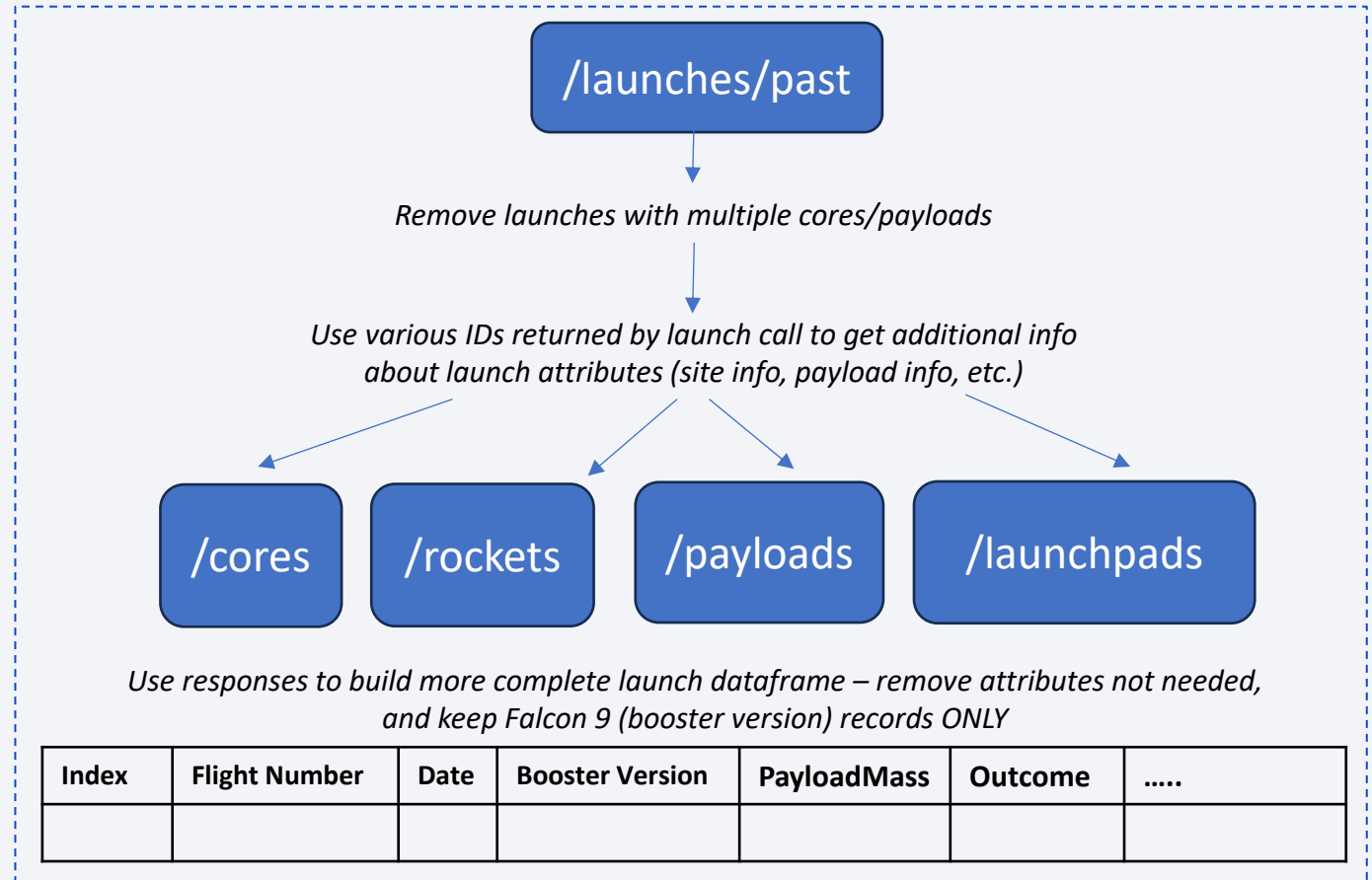
- Data collection methodology:
 - SpaceX API and Wikipedia Webscraping
- Perform data wrangling
 - Describe how data was processed
- Perform exploratory data analysis (EDA) using visualization and SQL
- Perform interactive visual analytics using Folium and Plotly Dash
- Perform predictive analysis using classification models
 - How to build, tune, evaluate classification models

Data Collection

- SpaceX API
 - Performed API call for past **launch data** from <https://api.spacexdata.com/v4/launches/past>
 - Made additional calls for each returned launch to gather additional launch attributes such as **booster name**, **payload mass**, **launch site**, **orbit**, **landing type**, and **outcome**
- Wikipedia
 - Collected Falcon 9 historical launch data from Wikipedia page using web scraping tools: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/List_of_Falcon_9_and_Falcon_Heavy_launches

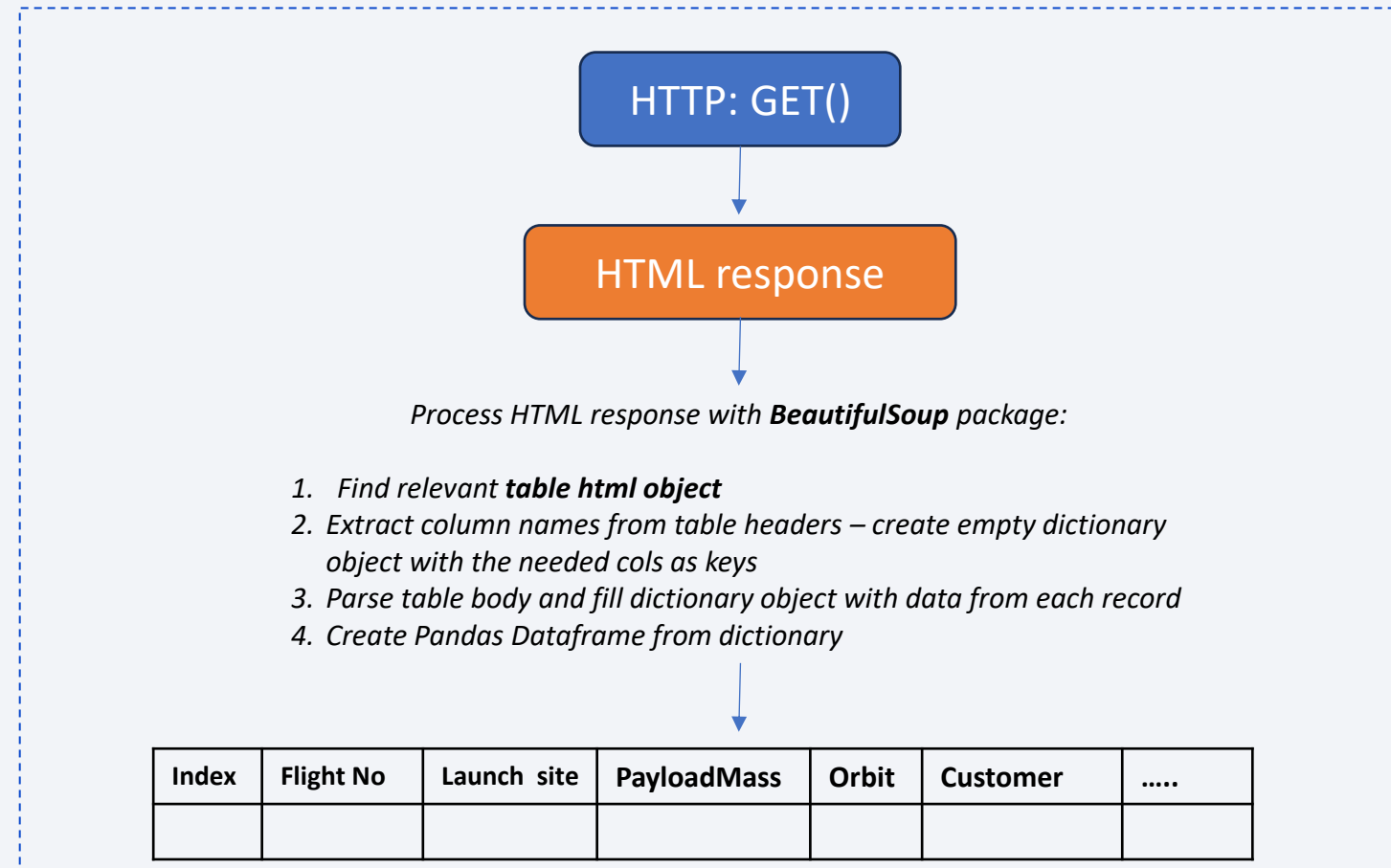
Data Collection – SpaceX API

- Performed API call (blue square in flow chart) for past launch data
- Made additional calls (blue squares) for each returned launch to gather additional launch attributes such as **booster name, payload mass, launch site, and outcome**
 - API endpoint:
<https://api.spacexdata.com/v4/>
- [GitHub URL – Data Collection](#)



Data Collection - Scraping

- Performed HTTP GET request to pull HTML from [this Wikipedia webpage](#)
- Used **BeautifulSoup** Python package to process HTML and prepared Pandas Dataframe with relevant dataset
- [GitHub URL - Webscraping](#)



Data Wrangling

- Performed Data Wrangling and Exploratory Data Analysis on retrieved data
- Observed the spread of launches across site, orbit, and outcome
- Categorized 'good' vs 'bad' outcomes into a binary column
- [GitHub URL – Data Wrangling](#)

Identified data types of the columns and missing values in columns

Determined number of launches: per site, per orbit, per outcome

```
LaunchSite
CCAFS SLC 40    55
KSC LC 39A     22
VAFB SLC 4E    13
Name: count, dtype: int64
```

```
Orbit
GTO    27
ISS    21
VLEO   14
PO      9
LEO     7
SSO     5
MEO     3
ES-L1   1
HEO     1
SO      1
GEO     1
```

```
Outcome
True ASDS    41
None None    19
True RTLS    14
False ASDS    6
True Ocean    5
False Ocean   2
None ASDS     2
False RTLS    1
```

Identified unsuccessful outcomes

```
{'False ASDS', 'False Ocean', 'False RTLS', 'None ASDS', 'None None'}
```

Marked launch records with **bad** outcome as *Class* = 0 (*Class*= 1 for **good** outcomes)
Took the mean of *Class* column to determine success rate of the launches

```
In [39]: df["Class"].mean()

Out[39]: 0.6666666666666666
```

EDA with Data Visualization

- Used PyPlot from Matplotlib to plot the outcomes (*Class*) using number of attributes in order to identify patterns and relationships:
 - Flight Number and Payload Mass
 - Flight Number and Launch Site
 - Payload and Launch Site
 - Success Rate (from *Class*) and Orbit
 - Flight Number and Orbit Type
 - Orbit Type vs Payload Mass
 - Launch Success Yearly Trend
- [GitHub URL – EDA with Data Viz](#)

See **Results** section
for charts and
descriptions of
identified trends

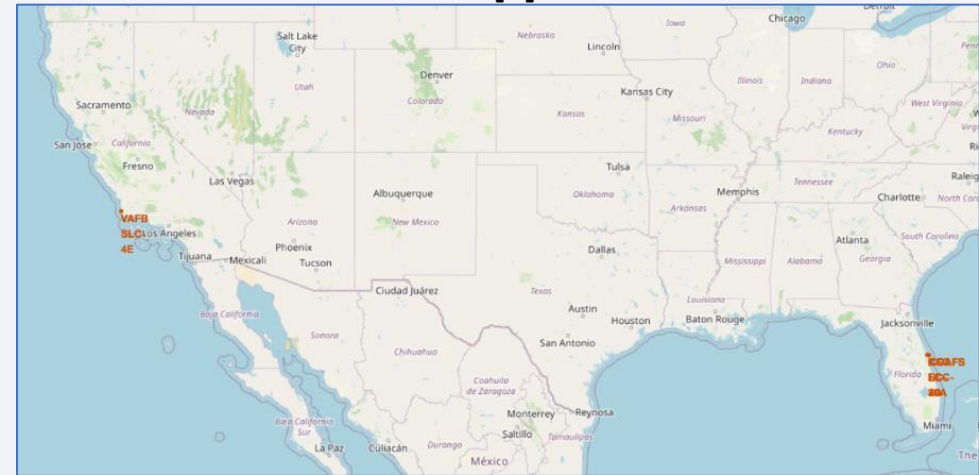
EDA with SQL

- Created SQL table using SQLite
- SQL Queries performed for further analysis:
 - Identified names of the distinct Launch Sites
 - Summed the Payload Mass for all launches for customer NASA (CRS)
 - Calculated average Payload Mass carried by Booster version F9 v1.1
 - Determined first successful landing date using ground pad
 - Identified boosters that have success in drone ship landings where the Payload Mass was between 4k - 6k (kg)
 - Determined the number of successful/failed missions by outcome
 - Identified boosters that have carried the maximum Payload Mass
 - Pulled the records that had failed drone ship landings in 2015
 - Counted number landings per Landing Outcome between the period of 2010-06-04 and 2017-03-20
- [GitHub URL – EDA SQL](#)

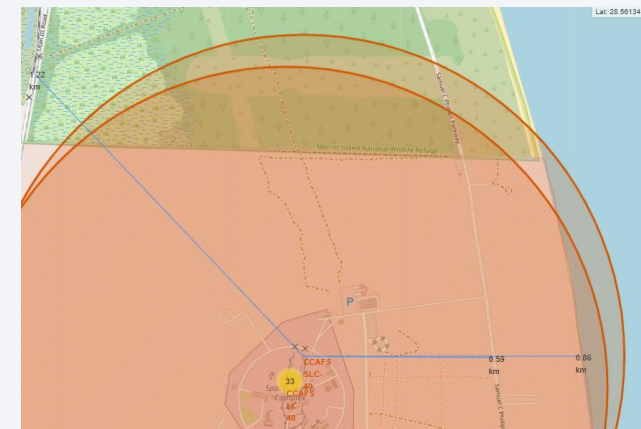
Interactive Map with Folium

- Created map with markers [1] at locations of the following Space X launch sites:
 - CCAFS LC-40
 - CCAFS SLC-40
 - KSC LC-39A
 - VAFB SLC-4E
- Added marker clusters at each site to show successful (green) and failed (red) launches [2]
- Drew lines and calculated distance to various landmarks [3]:
 - Railway
 - Highway
 - Coastline
- [GitHub URL - Folium](#)

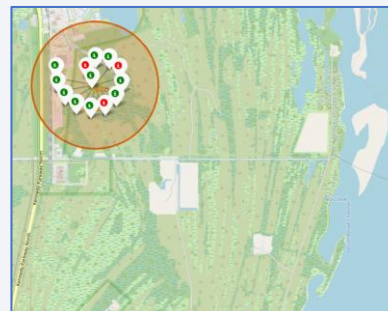
[1]



[3]



[2]

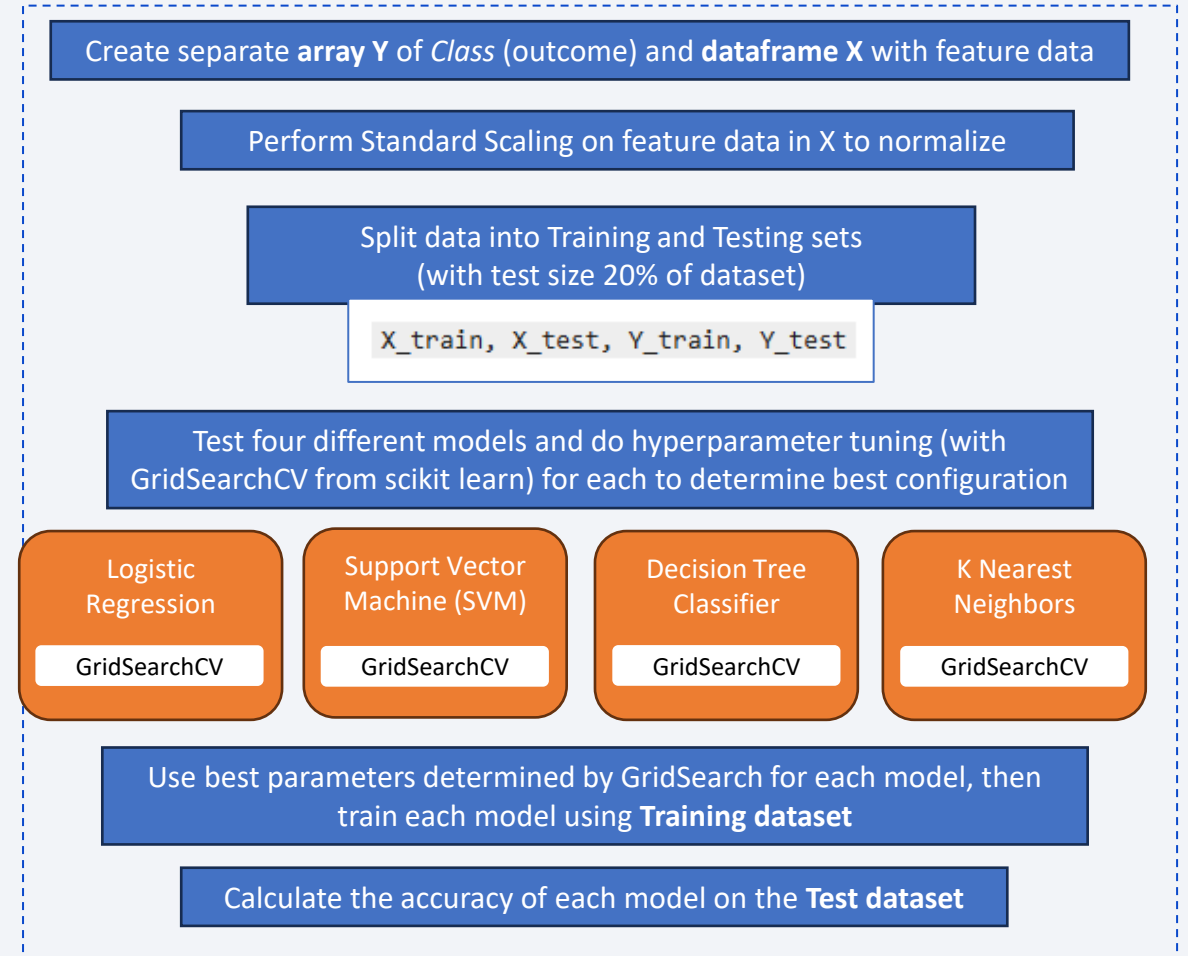


Dashboard with Plotly Dash

- Used Plotly library to create a dashboard that shows:
 - % of Successful Launches by Launch Site
 - Success/Failure % by individual Launch Site
 - Correlation between Payload and Success
- Used these visualization to understand how launch success correlated with features such as Launch Site and Payload Mass
- [GitHub URL – Plotly Dashboard](#)

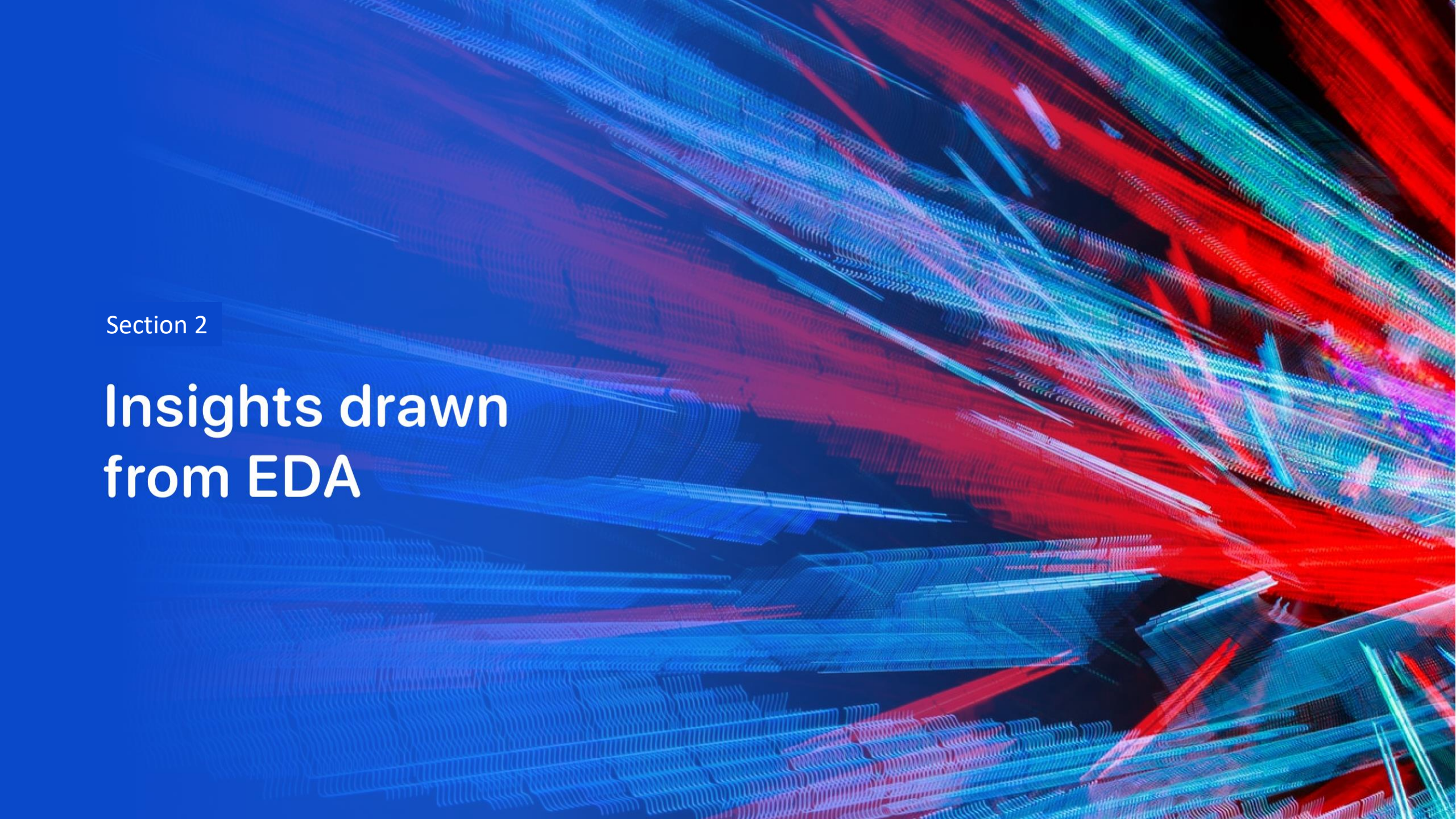
Predictive Analysis (Classification)

- Built models using four different models, determining the best parameters for each model
- Used Train/Test data split to train then evaluate the model
- Evaluated the accuracy of each model option
- [GitHub URL – Predictive Analysis](#)



Results

- Launch success generally improved over time
- Launches more frequently done with smaller payloads
- Large payload launches are only done from specific Launch Sites
- Success rates were better for certain orbit types
- Payload seems dependent on the orbit type of the launch
- Various models tested performed with similar accuracy, therefore any could be utilized for prediction
- Launch Site location depends on variety of factors such as proximity to coastline, railways, and cities

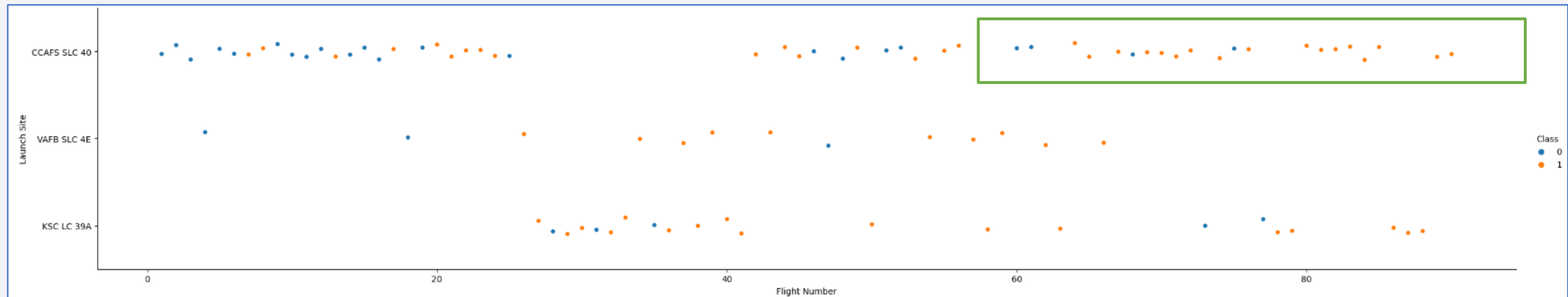
The background of the slide is an abstract composition. It features a dark blue base color. Overlaid on this are numerous diagonal streaks in shades of red and cyan. A faint, light blue grid pattern is also visible, particularly in the lower half of the image. The overall effect is dynamic and technological.

Section 2

Insights drawn from EDA

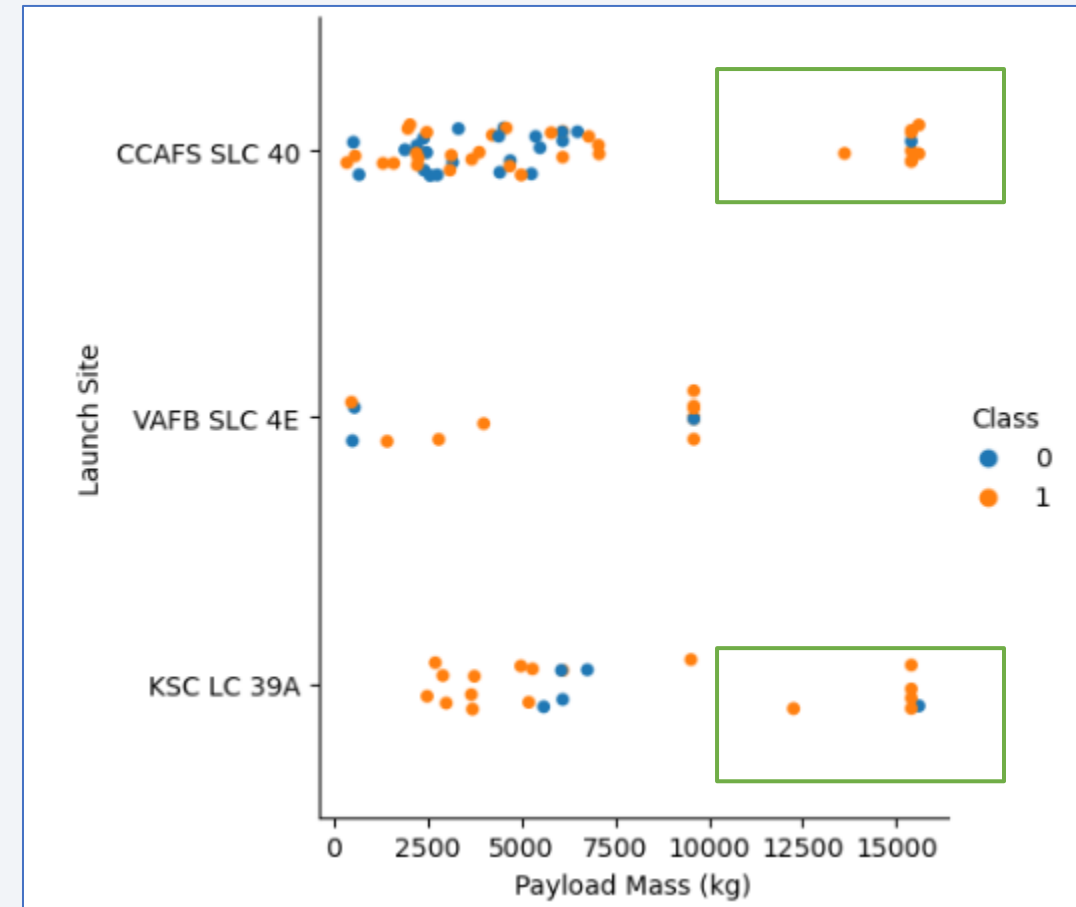
Flight Number vs. Launch Site

- Observed an **increasing success rate** for launches at **CCAFS SLC 40** as the flight number increases. So, as time went on and they performed more launches, the success improved.



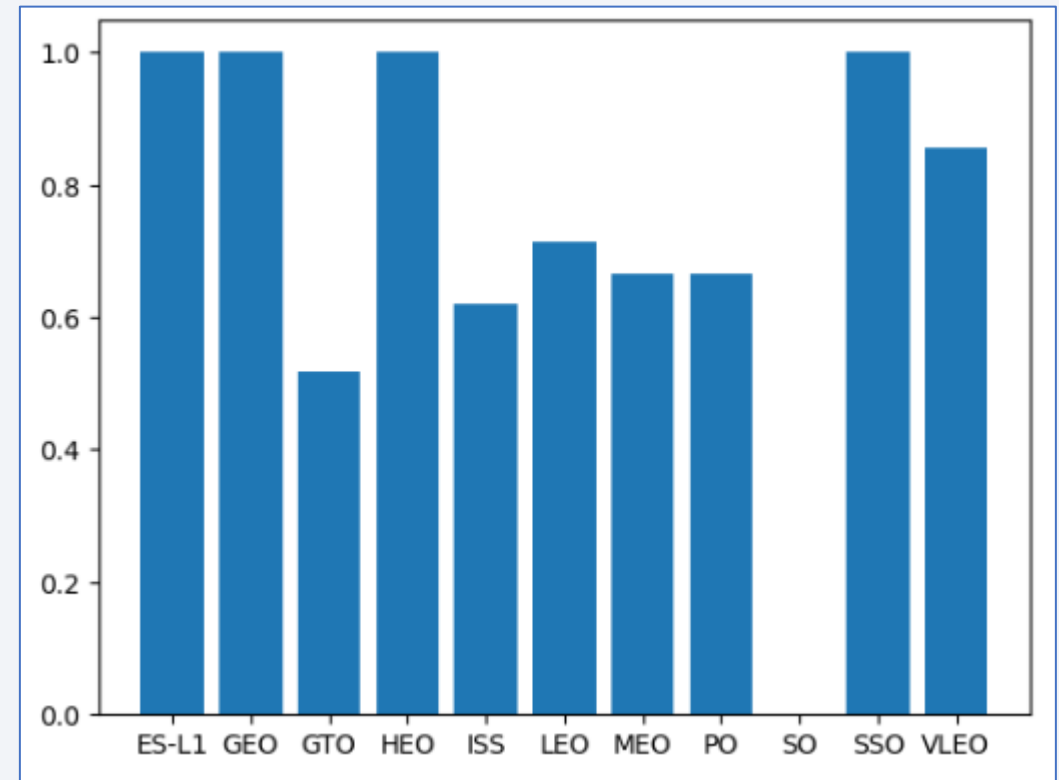
Payload vs. Launch Site

- Observed that **large payloads were only launched at CCAFS SLC 40 and KSC LC 39A sites**
 - Large payload being greater than 10k kg
 - Site VAFB SLC 4E was only used for smaller payloads



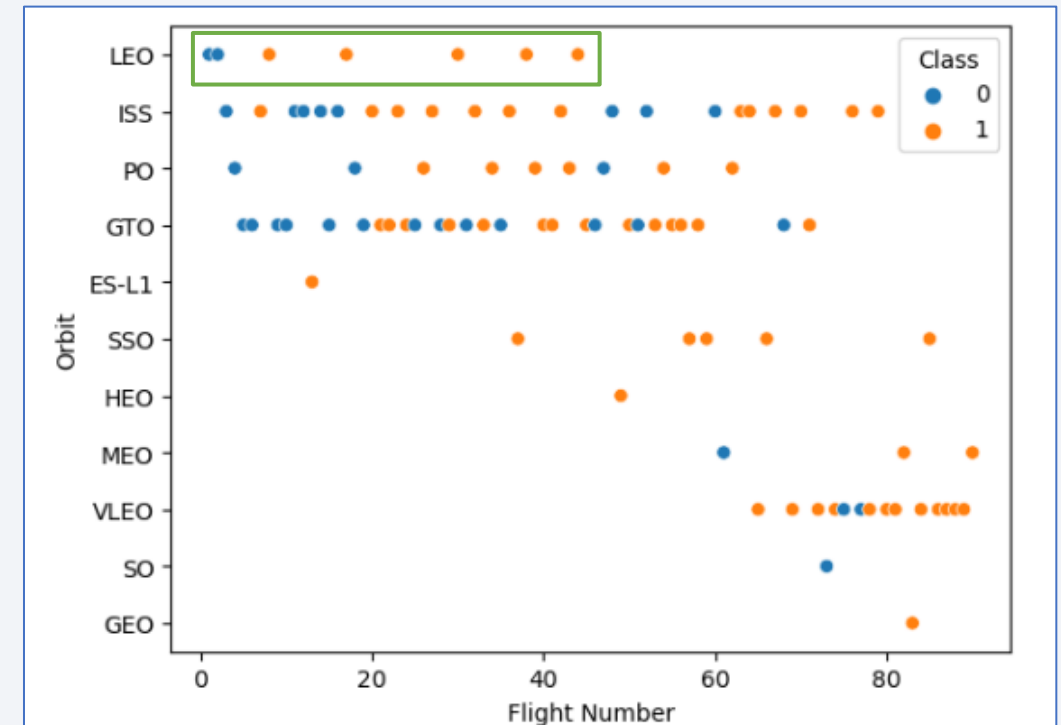
Success Rate vs. Orbit Type

- Observed that success rates are highest for the following orbits:
 - ES-L1
 - GEO
 - HEO
 - SSO



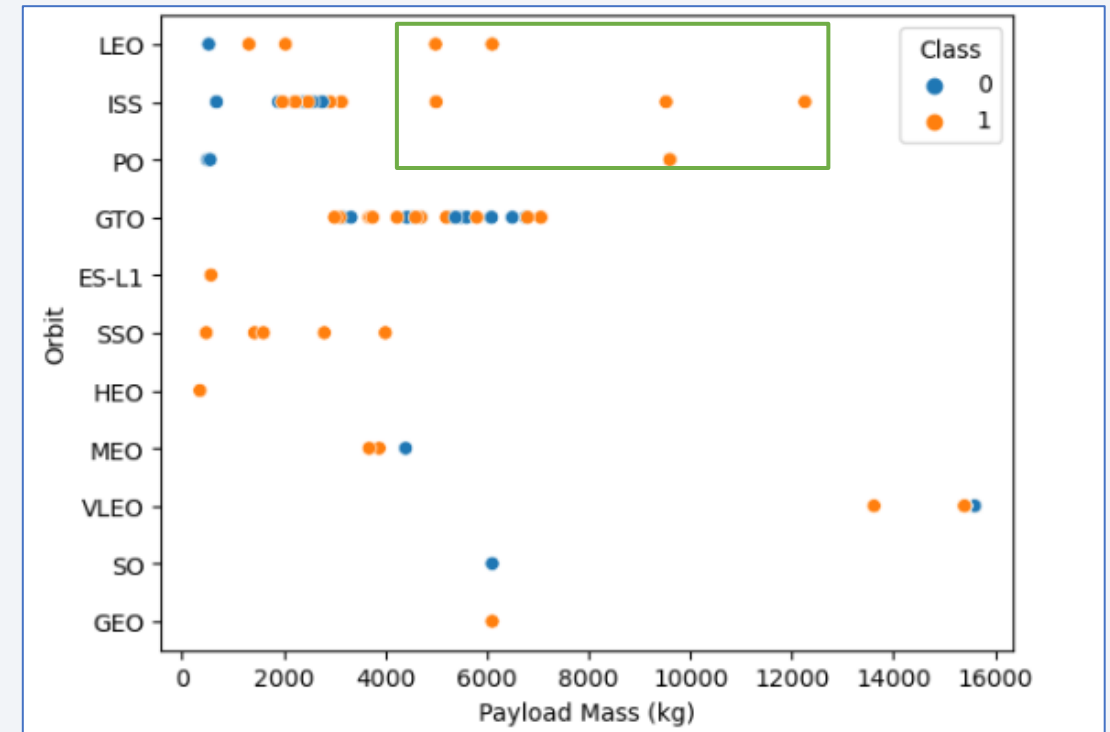
Flight Number vs. Orbit Type

- Observed that success for LEO appears related to Flight Number
 - improved success as they did more launches
- Other Orbit Types did not appear to have a clear relationship with Flight Number



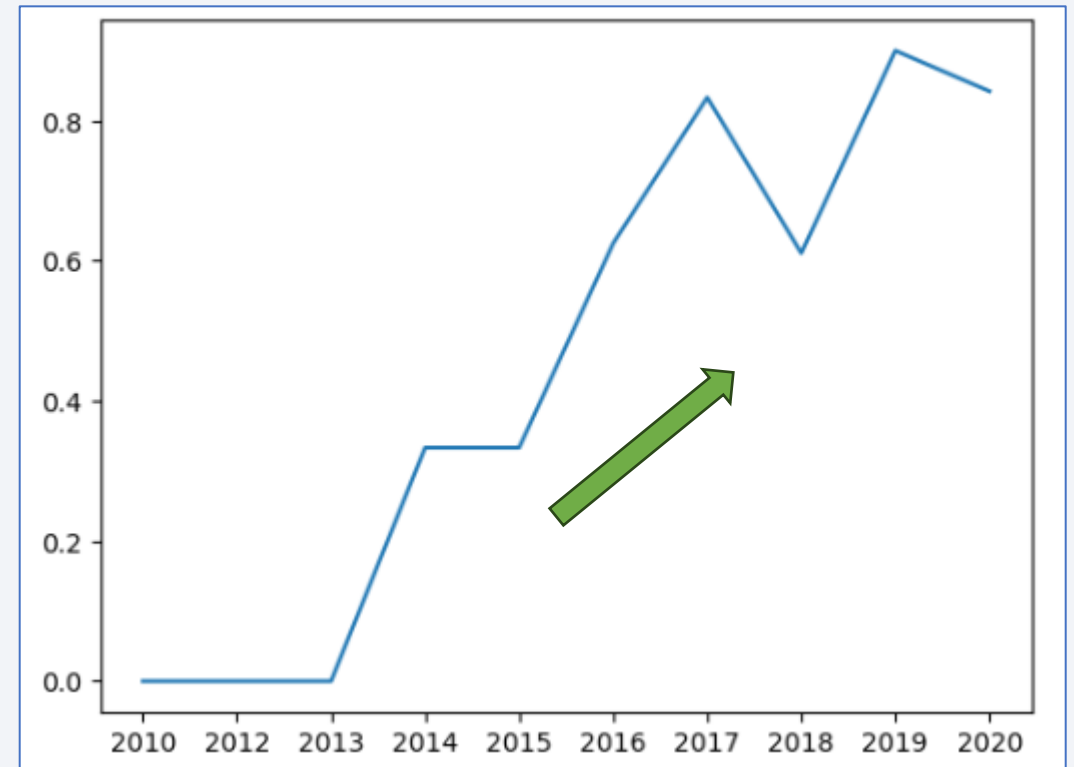
Payload vs. Orbit Type

- Observed higher successful landing rates for heavy payloads in **PO, LEO, ISS** orbits
- Observed that some Orbit Types never see a large payload (>8k):
 - GTO
 - MEO
 - ES-L1
 - SO
 - SSO
 - GEO
 - HEO



Launch Success Yearly Trend

- Success rate **generally increasing over time**, with some peaks and valleys between
 - Success rate steady from 2014 to 2015
 - Decreased success rate from 2017 to 2018



All Launch Site Names

- Find the names of the unique launch sites
 - There are 4 unique launch sites

```
%sql select DISTINCT Launch_Site FROM SPACEXTABLE
```

```
* sqlite:///my_data1.db
```

```
Done.
```

Launch_Site
CCAFS LC-40
VAFB SLC-4E
KSC LC-39A
CCAFS SLC-40

Launch Site Names Begin with 'CCA'

- Find 5 records where launch sites begin with `CCA`
 - Record returned will either be from launch site CCAFS LC-40 and CCAFS SLC-40

```
%sql SELECT * FROM SPACEXTABLE WHERE Launch_Site LIKE 'CCA%' LIMIT 5
```

```
* sqlite:///my_data1.db  
Done.
```

Date	Time (UTC)	Booster_Version	Launch_Site	Payload	PAYLOAD_MASS_KG_	Orbit	Customer	Mission_Outcome	Landing_Outcome
2010-06-04	18:45:00	F9 v1.0 B0003	CAAFS LC-40	Dragon Spacecraft Qualification Unit	0	LEO	SpaceX	Success	Failure (parachute)
2010-12-08	15:43:00	F9 v1.0 B0004	CAAFS LC-40	Dragon demo flight C1, two CubeSats, barrel of Brouere cheese	0	LEO (ISS)	NASA (COTS) NRO	Success	Failure (parachute)
2012-05-22	7:44:00	F9 v1.0 B0005	CAAFS LC-40	Dragon demo flight C2	525	LEO (ISS)	NASA (COTS)	Success	No attempt
2012-10-08	0:35:00	F9 v1.0 B0006	CAAFS LC-40	SpaceX CRS-1	500	LEO (ISS)	NASA (CRS)	Success	No attempt
2013-03-01	15:10:00	F9 v1.0 B0007	CAAFS LC-40	SpaceX CRS-2	677	LEO (ISS)	NASA (CRS)	Success	No attempt

Total Payload Mass

- Calculate the total payload carried by boosters from NASA

```
%sql SELECT Customer, SUM(PAYLOAD_MASS__KG_) as Payload_Total FROM SPACEXTABLE WHERE Customer='NASA (CRS)'
```

```
* sqlite:///my_data1.db
```

```
Done.
```

Customer	Payload_Total
NASA (CRS)	45596

Average Payload Mass by F9 v1.1

- Calculate the average payload mass carried by booster version F9 v1.1

```
%sql SELECT Booster_Version, AVG(PAYLOAD_MASS__KG_) as Avg_Payload FROM SPACEXTABLE WHERE Booster_Version LIKE 'F9 v1.1%'
```

```
* sqlite:///my_data1.db
```

```
Done.
```

Booster_Version	Avg_Payload
-----------------	-------------

F9 v1.1 B1003	2534.6666666666665
---------------	--------------------

First Successful Ground Landing Date

- Find the dates of the first successful landing outcome on ground pad

```
%sql SELECT MIN(Date) as EarliestSuccessful, Landing_Outcome FROM SPACEXTABLE WHERE Landing_Outcome = 'Success (ground pad)'
```

```
* sqlite:///my_data1.db
```

```
Done.
```

EarliestSuccessful	Landing_Outcome
--------------------	-----------------

2015-12-22	Success (ground pad)
------------	----------------------

Successful Drone Ship Landing with Payload between 4000 and 6000

- List the names of boosters which have successfully landed on drone ship and had payload mass greater than 4000 but less than 6000

```
%sql SELECT DISTINCT Booster_Version FROM SPACEXTABLE WHERE PAYLOAD_MASS__KG_>4000 and PAYLOAD_MASS__KG_<6000 and Landing_Outcome='Success (drone ship)'
```

```
* sqlite:///my_data1.db
```

```
Done.
```

Booster_Version
F9 FT B1022
F9 FT B1026
F9 FT B1021.2
F9 FT B1031.2

Total Number of Successful and Failure Mission Outcomes

- Calculate the total number of successful and failure mission outcomes

```
%sql SELECT Mission_Outcome, COUNT(*) as MissionCount FROM SPACEXTABLE GROUP BY Mission_Outcome
```

```
* sqlite:///my_data1.db
```

```
Done.
```

Mission_Outcome	MissionCount
Failure (in flight)	1
Success	98
Success	1
Success (payload status unclear)	1

Boosters Carried Maximum Payload

- List the names of the booster which have carried the maximum payload mass

```
%sql SELECT DISTINCT Booster_Version FROM SPACEXTABLE WHERE PAYLOAD_MASS_KG_=(SELECT MAX(PAYLOAD_MASS_KG_) FROM SPACEXTABLE)
* sqlite:///my_data1.db
Done.
```

Booster_Version
F9 B5 B1048.4
F9 B5 B1049.4
F9 B5 B1051.3
F9 B5 B1056.4
F9 B5 B1048.5
F9 B5 B1051.4
F9 B5 B1049.5
F9 B5 B1060.2
F9 B5 B1058.3
F9 B5 B1051.6
F9 B5 B1060.3
F9 B5 B1049.7

2015 Launch Records

- List the failed landing_outcomes in drone ship, their booster versions, and launch site names for in year 2015

```
SELECT substr(Date,6,2) as Month, Landing_Outcome, Booster_Version, Launch_Site FROM SPACEXTABLE WHERE substr(Date,0,5)='2015' AND Landing_Outcome='Failure'
```

* sqlite:///my_data1.db
Done.

Month	Landing_Outcome	Booster_Version	Launch_Site
01	Failure (drone ship)	F9 v1.1 B1012	CCAFS LC-40
04	Failure (drone ship)	F9 v1.1 B1015	CCAFS LC-40

Rank Landing Outcomes Between 2010-06-04 and 2017-03-20

- Rank the count of landing outcomes (such as Failure (drone ship) or Success (ground pad)) between the date 2010-06-04 and 2017-03-20, in descending order

```
%sql SELECT Landing_Outcome, COUNT(*) as Ct FROM SPACESTATION WHERE DATE>'2010-06-04' AND DATE<'2017-03-20' GROUP BY Landing_Outcome ORDER BY Ct DESC
```

```
* sqlite:///my_data1.db
```

```
Done.
```

Landing_Outcome	Ct
No attempt	10
Success (drone ship)	5
Failure (drone ship)	5
Success (ground pad)	3
Controlled (ocean)	3
Uncontrolled (ocean)	2
Precluded (drone ship)	1
Failure (parachute)	1

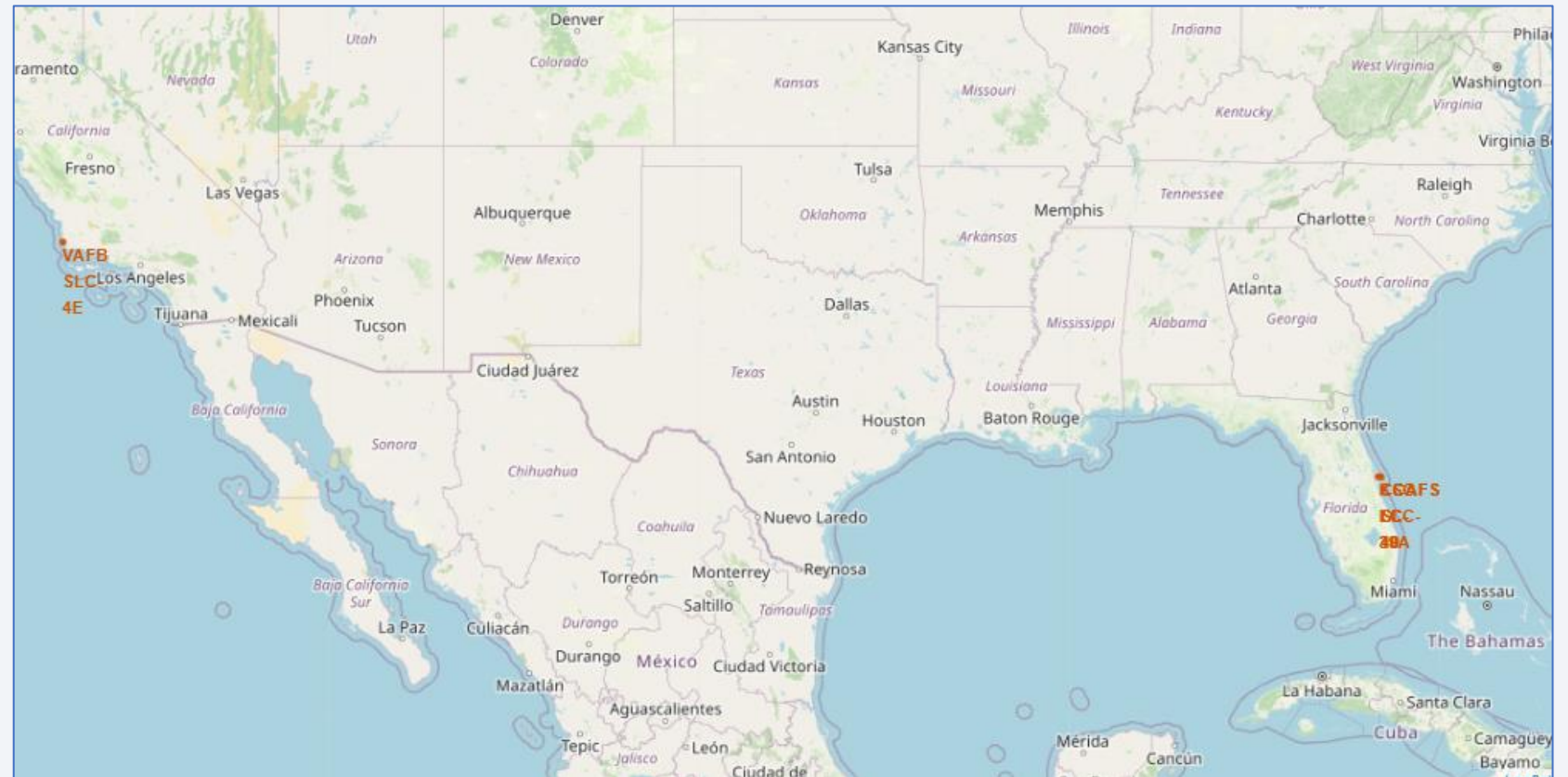
A satellite view of Earth from space, showing the curvature of the planet and city lights at night. The background is a deep blue gradient.

Section 3

Launch Sites Proximities Analysis

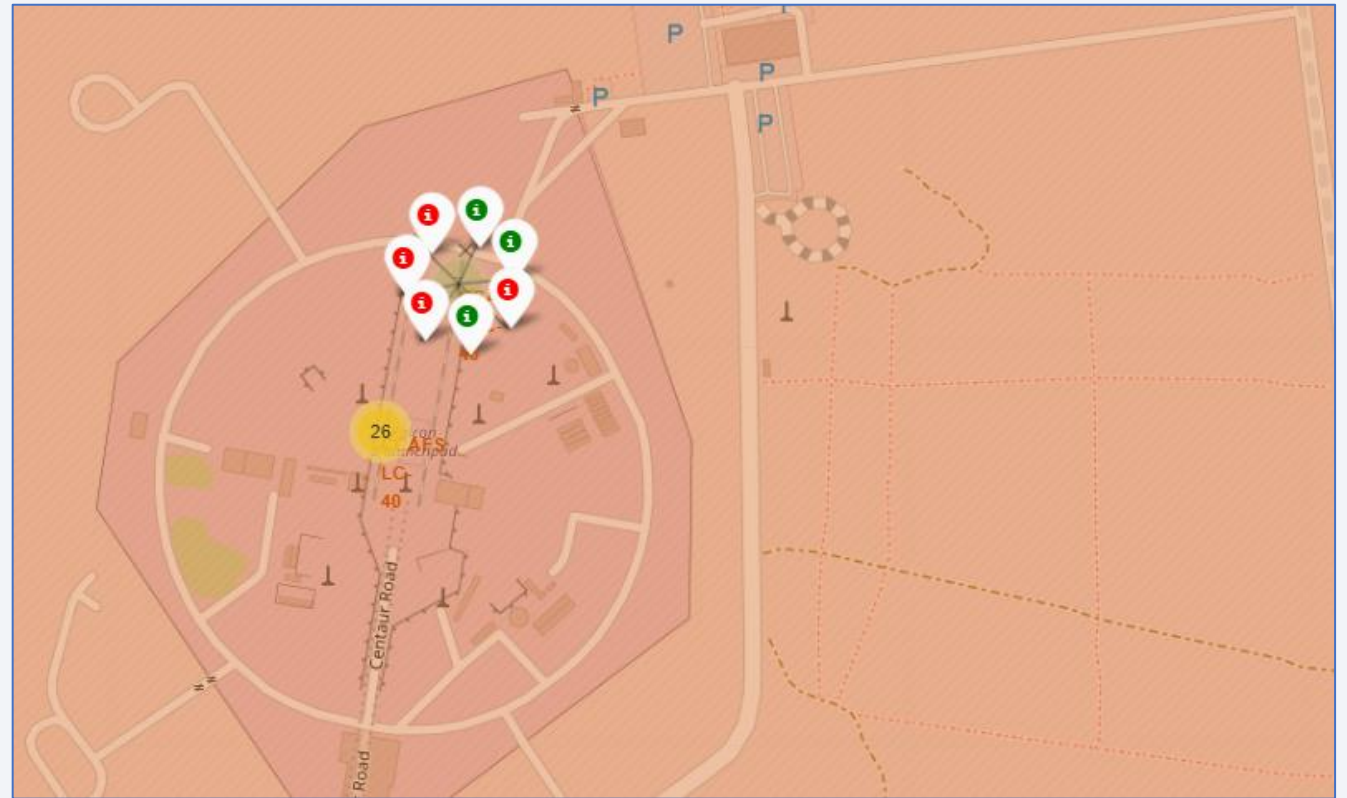
Map with Launch Site Markers

- Locations marked in orange for following Launch Sites
 - CCAFS LC-40
 - CCAFS SLC-40
 - KSC LC-39A
 - VAFB SLC-4E
- First 3 sites are clustered in Florida



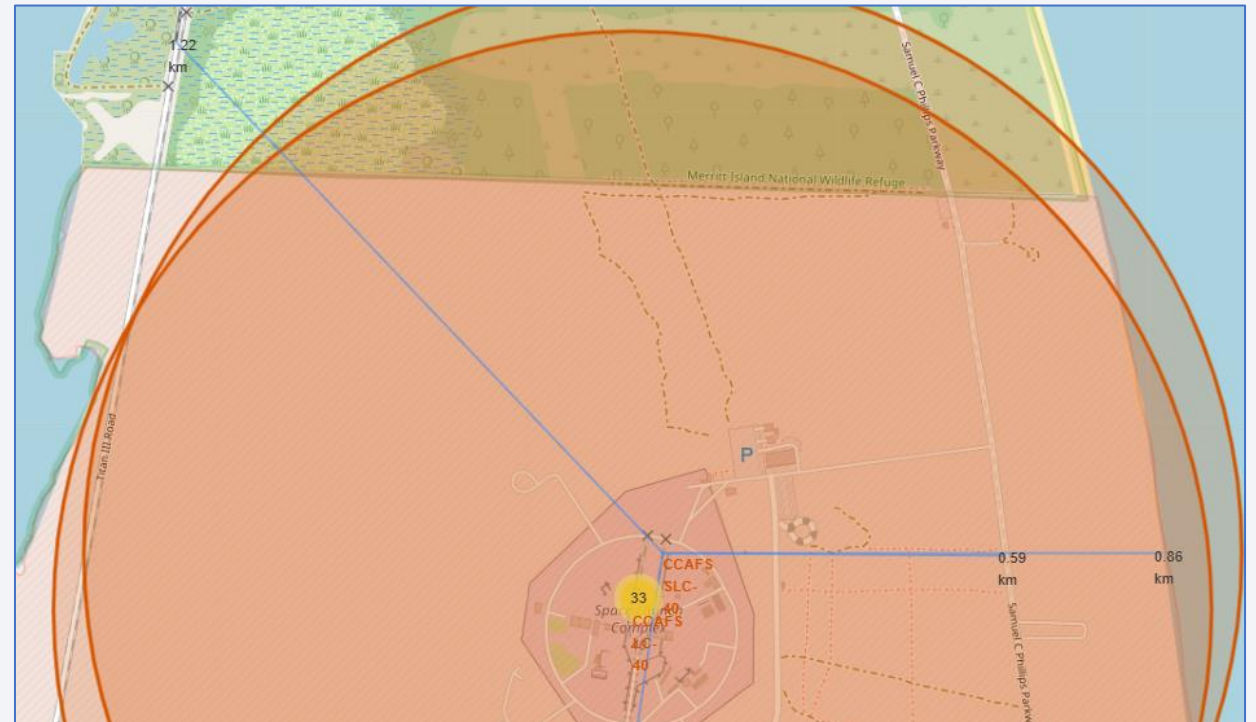
Launch Results by Outcome

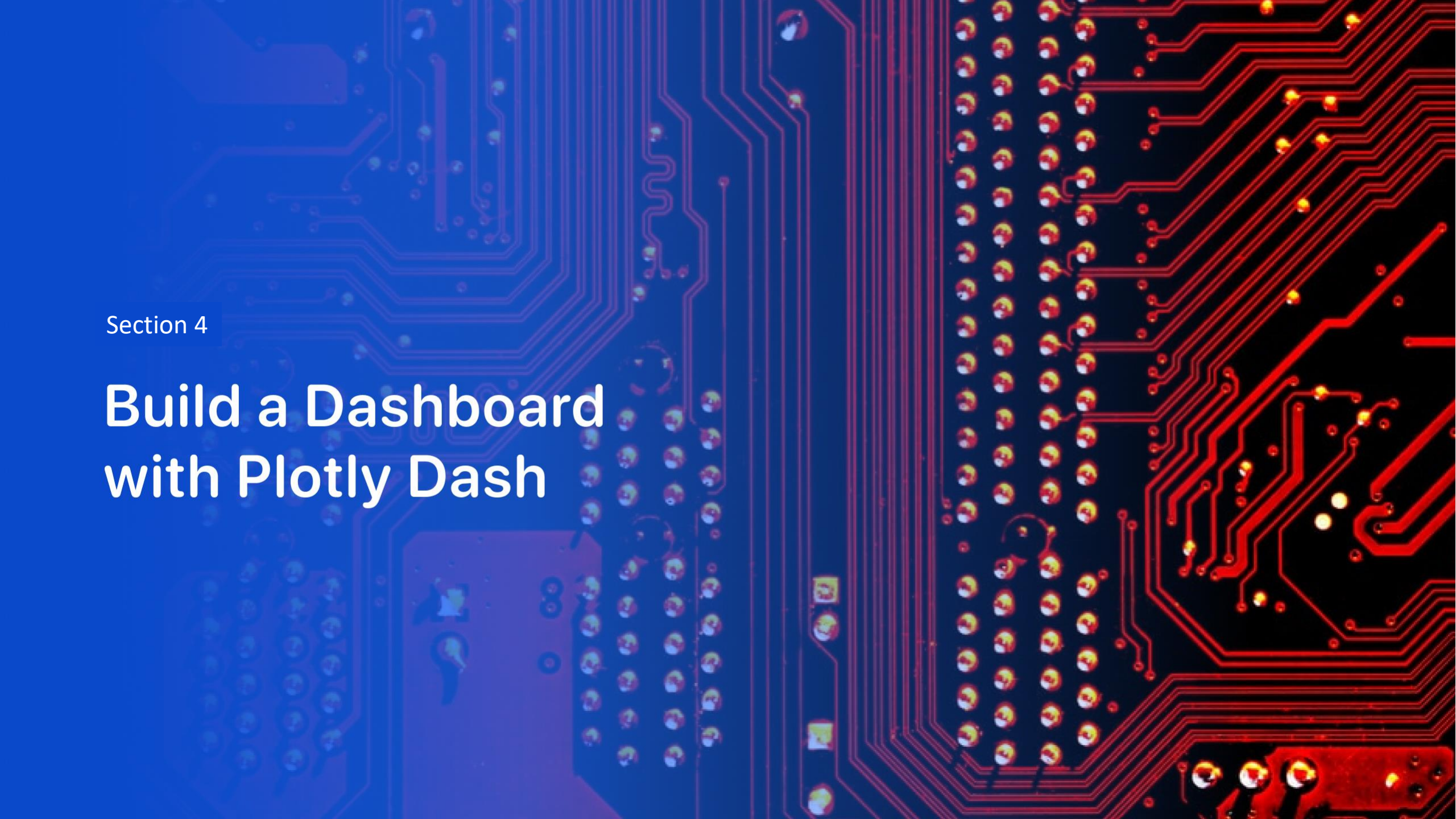
- Folium map zooms in on launch sites and shows indicators for successful (green) and (failed) launches at that site
 - Screenshot shows result markers 7 launches at the CCAFS SLC 40 site



Distance from Landmarks

- Plotted launch site proximity to various landmarks such as railway, highway, coastline. Distances are calculated and displayed.
 - All launch sites appear to be within a certain proximity this is possibly due to water landings being an option
 - Distance between launch sites and railways appears to be needed, but they are in the general vicinity
 - Appears that a significant distance needed between launch site and cities – this is possibly due to safety concerns



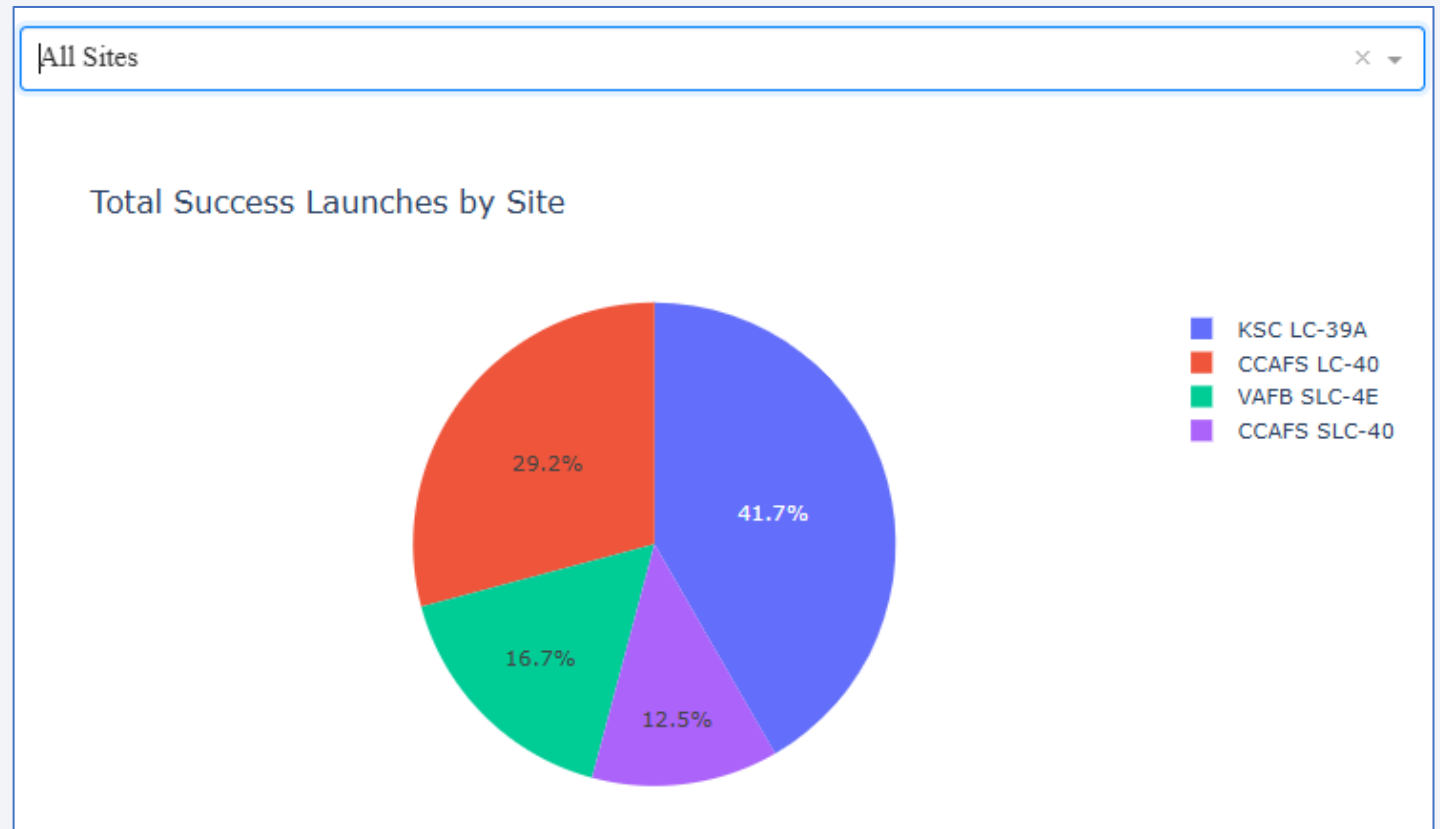


Section 4

Build a Dashboard with Plotly Dash

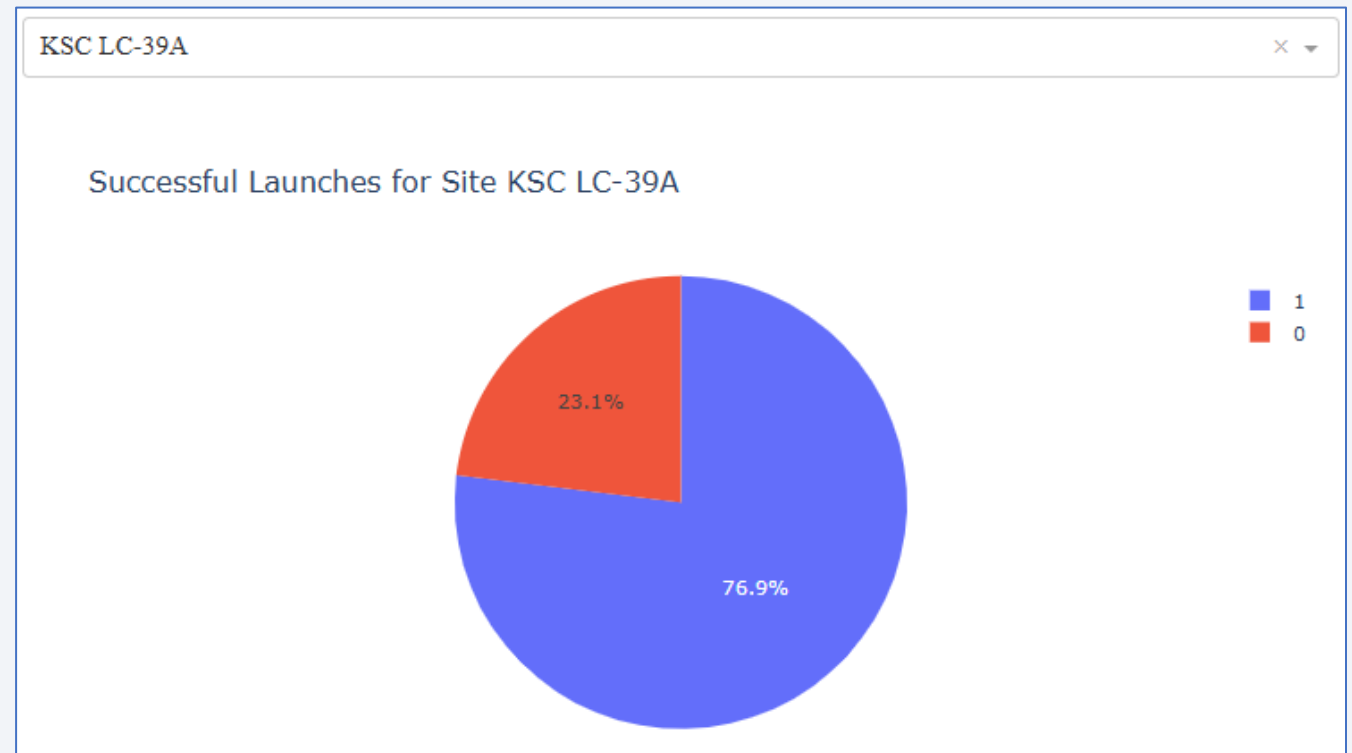
Successful Launch Results for All Sites

- Visual shows total successful launches broken out by Launch Site
- Site **KSC LC-39A** has most significant amount of successful launches



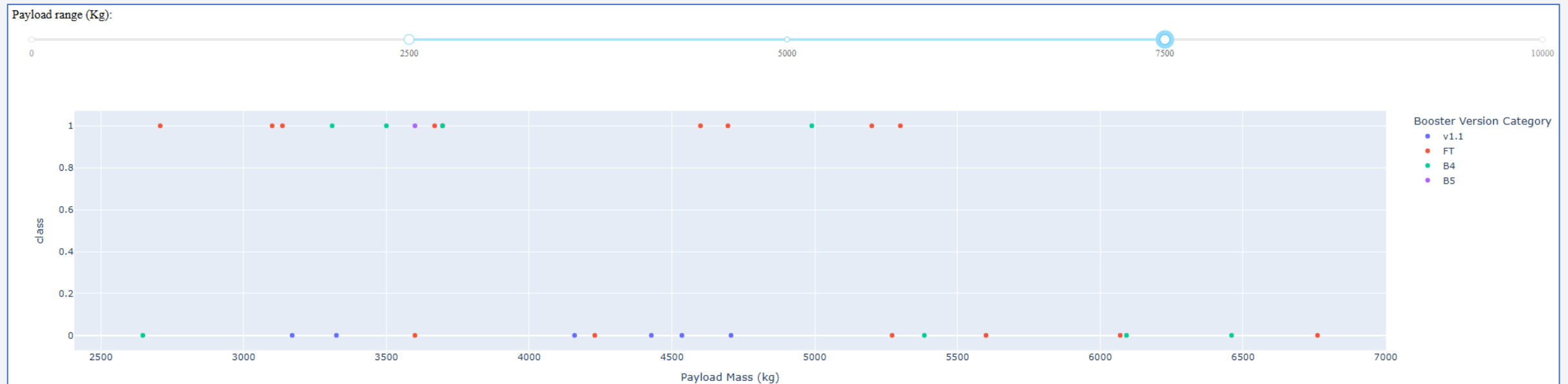
Launch Successes and Failures for KSC LC-39A

- Selecting just the site with the most successes (**KSC LC-39A**) allows us to see successes (blue) vs failures (red) for that site
- App allows you to other individual sites to see their successes vs failures



Payload vs Class (success or failure)

- Select Payload Mass range using the slider
- 1 indicates Success, 0 indicates Failure
- Color indicates Booster Version
 - Observed more launches for smaller payloads (compared to larger payloads)

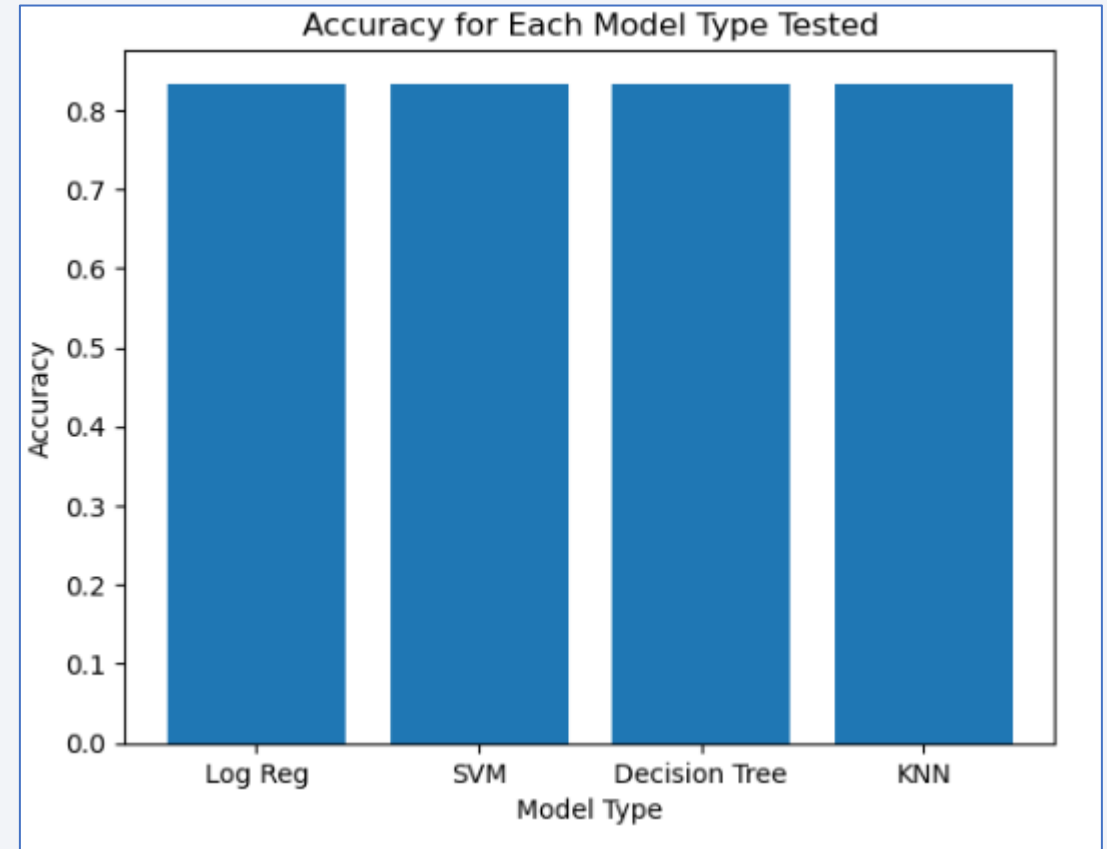


Section 5

Predictive Analysis (Classification)

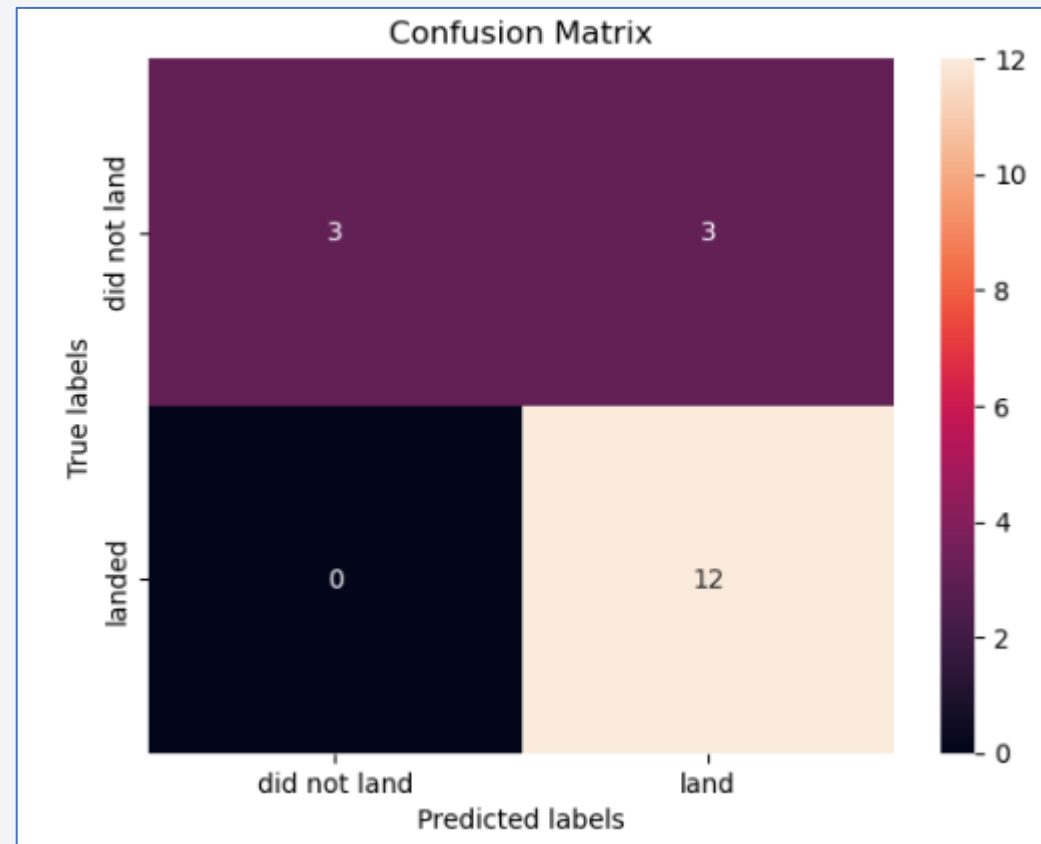
Classification Accuracy

- All models tested appear to perform with the same accuracy (shown to right)
- Likely due to this being a small dataset



Confusion Matrix

- All models showed the same **confusion matrix** due to having the same accuracy



Conclusions

- Launch success was found to be related to a number of different factors
 - Launch success generally improved over time
 - Launches more frequently done with smaller payloads
 - Large payload launches are only done from specific Launch Sites
 - Success rates were better for certain orbit types
 - Payload seems dependent on the orbit type of the launch
 - Various models tested performed with similar accuracy, therefore any could be utilized for prediction
 - Launch Site location depends on variety of factors such as proximity to coastline, railways, and cities

Appendix

- Associated scripts and files found here:
 - <https://github.com/lbley24/data-science-course>

Thank you!

